

Sony SRS XV800

A fantastic albeit pricey party Bluetooth speaker

At the Digit Test Labs, we've tested a fair share of Sony's Bluetooth speakers.

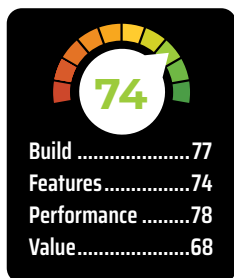
However, most of these were compact and extremely portable. This time around we got a monster of a speaker from Sony for review. The Sony SRS XV800 is being advertised as a speaker that wears many feathers in its cap. Sony says that this Bluetooth speaker is capable enough to be your home entertainment speaker, karaoke machine, and even a party speaker. The Sony SRS XV800 is a hefty battery-powered Bluetooth speaker that packs an array of speakers to provide users with impactful sound. However, at 18.5 kilograms of weight, it is anything but portable. Also, the speaker isn't exactly affordable at a whopping ₹49,990. Does it still make for a compelling option for your home parties? Let's delve into this in my review of the Sony SRS XV800.

BUILD, DESIGN AND I/O

Most Bluetooth speakers you see in the market are meant to be portable – not this one though. Weighing in at a hefty 18.5 kg, the Sony SRS XV800 is ludicrously hard to lug around. In fact, just getting the speaker out of its retail box was a workout. The speaker's body is made up of plastic and metal, and it feels extremely durable and well-built. There are wheels on the bottom to move it around but you have to tilt the speaker quite far before it starts rolling with ease.

The Sony SRS XV800 is also quite tall; like a big cabinet for your PC. So, you should be mindful of the space you have in your home before buying

₹49,990



it. It comes with LED lights that strobe in time with the music and you can change the lighting effects via the accompanying app which we'll talk about more later. The speaker can be plugged into an electrical outlet or on battery via its 10,520

mAh battery.

The speaker is also IPX4 rated when placed vertically, and IPX2 when placed horizontally, meaning it should be able to survive light rain (when placed vertically) if you're having a party in your verandah or garden out-

doors. There are several touch controls on the top of the speaker that allow you to change inputs, pause and play, adjust volume levels, and even turn on Mega Bass mode for those who want the extra thump.

For I/O, it has a plethora of connectivity options such as Bluetooth, two quarter-inch inputs for microphones or instruments such as guitars, a 3.5 mm audio jack, and optical input for using it with a television. There's no XLR input though, which means that some industry-standard microphones cannot be connected directly. You would need an adapter or a supported cable for those. There's also a USB-A port which can be used to charge your devices such as smartphones and tablets via the speaker's gargantuan battery.

FEATURES

The Sony SRS XV800 comes with Bluetooth version 5.2 and supports the SBC, AAC and LDAC codecs. It supports immersive 360-degree sound, according to Sony. The sound is immersive and fills a mid to large-sized room with ease. It should be loud enough for outdoor parties as well, although we didn't get to test the outdoor aspect. Sony also allows you to connect the SRS XV800 to other supported Sony speakers for a more immersive experience.

As I mentioned before, you can plug in guitars and microphones to the speaker to organise a karaoke, have a jamming session, and more. The supporting app allows users to add a slight echo effect as well, which is pretty neat.

Speaking of the app, the speaker is supported on both the Sony Music Center and Fiestable apps. The app allows you to customise many aspects of the speaker including the light effects, adjust the equaliser, and more. There are some features missing such as Wi-Fi connectivity and voice assistant support. However, the features on offer are unique and conducive to a party environment. Especially, the fun DJ sound effects that you can add to tracks that are playing. Fun stuff!